

examined several advertisements in the classified section of the paper. Finally he decided on a low-mileage model offered by a local dealer. As he explained:

Automobiles? I have always placed a premium on quality. But I never lease, never finance. I drive a Mercedes-Benz. Since I started my practice, I have only had two cars. The first, a Mercedes, I purchased new just after I opened my practice.... Kept it twenty years. Then I bought my second car ... a three-year-old Mercedes. I went to a dealer.... He wanted to sell me a new one. But it was \$20,000 more than the used one on the lot.

Then I just asked myself a simple question: Is the “pride of new car ownership”—and that’s all it is, pride—worth \$20,000? The cars are the same. The answer is no. The “pride of new car ownership” is not worth \$20,000.

The North method took only a few hours. Contrast this with Dr. South’s automobile-purchasing crusade—a process that took him at least sixty hours. And, of course, Dr. North likes to keep his cars for a long time. So his allocation of purchasing time is spread over several years. On average, he devotes less than an hour a year to purchasing motor vehicles. But Dr. South likes to buy a new car every year. Thus, his sixty-hour project is typically allocated to only one year.